The Waterfront Brief

Weekly sustainment intelligence for naval shipyard leadership · Naval shipbuilding, ship repair, and fleet sustainment

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Two yard periods the Navy booked will end before their ships come home, and the repair period last year's budget booked for a destroyer that lost power at sea in July is missing from this year's funded list. Keyport, meanwhile, has put a number on the parts it pulls from retired ships. This is a short issue: three dated items to watch, then the events calendar.

ON THE WATCH

Three things to watch

Two booked yard periods end before their ships come home. The Navy's April 2026 operations budget book books the destroyer John Finn's repair period at its home port of Yokosuka, Japan, from Nov. 2 to Jan. 19, and the carrier George H.W. Bush's maintenance period at Portsmouth, Va., from Nov. 22 to Jan. 6. John Finn's families were told to expect the ship next March, Defense One reported. Bush left Norfolk on March 31, the Navy announced. Sailors deploying with carrier groups are told to expect 10 to 11 months away, USNI News reported on Oct. 29. By our count, that puts Bush home in late January or later, after its booked window has closed.

A destroyer that went dark in July has dropped off the funded repair list. Benfold lost generator power on July 24 and was towed to Subic Bay, USNI News reported in August. It returned to Everett, Wash., on Oct. 16, Stars and Stripes reported, and USNI News reported on Nov. 5 that it "will now undergo maintenance." The Navy's fiscal 2026 budget book booked Benfold a $37 million private repair period on the West Coast from Oct. 26, 2026, to June 20, 2027. The April 2026 book's list of funded repair periods does not include it, and lists $2.1 million of Benfold's maintenance as unfunded and deferred. The record does not say whether the period was dropped, moved or paid for another way. The same USNI News report said the destroyer Stout lost power in port in Italy on Oct. 25 and had "full power restored within three days." The Navy named Benfold's generators; it has given no cause for Stout.

One center has put a number on what retired ships supply: $36 million a year. The Naval Undersea Warfare Center at Keyport said on Oct. 30, by its own count, that its teams have pulled parts from decommissioned ships generally and returned about $36 million a year to fleet sonar programs since fiscal 2025. The teams "expect their workload to double over the next five years" as Ohio-class submarines retire. "Each boat can provide up to 200 backorder fulfillments," project lead Bob Karp said in the release, meaning parts orders the supply system could not otherwise fill, and the parts ship "as-is" to Naval Supply Systems Command or the Defense Logistics Agency.

> **WHY IT MATTERS**
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> **Bottom line:** A repair period that drops off the funded list, as Benfold's did, can leave a ship home with work no funded schedule holds. Plan crews and pier time for that work against the windows long deployments are emptying, like Bush's and John Finn's.

Sources: The Navy's fiscal 2026 budget book; The Navy's April 2026 operations budget book; Defense One reported; the Navy announced; USNI News reported on Oct. 29; USNI News reported in August; Stars and Stripes reported; USNI News reported on Nov. 5; The Naval Undersea Warfare Center at Keyport said on Oct. 30

The Waterfront Brief is compiled weekly by the B2 vault's research engine from primary sources and verified trade reporting. Scope: US shipbuilding, US Navy sustainment, and partners across the Indo-Pacific region; out-of-area items only when there is a direct, stated lesson. Freshness policy: every article's anchor source is under 12 months old; older material appears only as dated context or a flagged exception. A linked sentence means the named source says it, not that this desk has independently verified it. Corrections welcome; staged sources are retained for audit.

UPCOMING EVENTS

Nearest first, filling the page. **Bold** marks a decision that closes inside the next 60 days. NSRP is the National Shipbuilding Research Program, the industry-Navy body that funds shared shipyard process research; SAE is SAE International, which runs the Department of War Maintenance Symposium; SNA is the Surface Navy Association; DSI is the Defense Strategies Institute; NDIA is the National Defense Industrial Association; AFCEA is the Armed Forces Communications and Electronics Association and USNI the U.S. Naval Institute; AMPP is the Association for Materials Protection and Performance; ASNE is the American Society of Naval Engineers; the AMDA Foundation is the Australian body that runs the Indo Pacific exposition.

Dates	Event	Register by	Why it matters
Dec 8-11, 2026	Department of War Maintenance Symposium 2026, Fort Lauderdale, FL (SAE for DoW)	**Open**	Maintenance execution: the department-wide depot maintenance meeting
Jan 12-14, 2027	SNA National Symposium 2027, Arlington, VA (SNA)	Not yet open	Program priorities: where the surface force states its maintenance priorities
Jan 26-28, 2027	Military Additive Manufacturing Summit (MILAM), Tampa, FL (DSI)	Early rate closed Oct 2	Additive qualification: defense additive qualification and NAVSEA-spec adoption
Feb 8-10, 2027	NDIA Annual Logistics Forum 2027, Renaissance Orlando at SeaWorld, Orlando, FL (NDIA)	Not printed	Supply chain: lifecycle sustainment and supply-chain community (the 41st forum)
Feb 16-18, 2027	WEST 2027, San Diego, CA (AFCEA/USNI)	Not printed	Program priorities: the Pacific-side sea services conference
Mar 23-25, 2027	NSRP All Panel Meeting 2027, North Charleston, SC (NSRP)	“Coming soon”	Regional capacity: where yard R&D ideas get teamed program-wide
Apr 4-7, 2027	Sea-Air-Space 2027, National Harbor, MD (Navy League)	Not yet open	Program priorities: the Navy League’s annual maritime exposition
Apr 11-15, 2027	AMPP Annual Conference + Expo 2027, Columbus, Ohio (AMPP)	Abstracts closed Oct 1; attendee registration not printed	Preservation: the corrosion and coatings association’s annual conference
Jun 8-10, 2027	MegaRust 2027, Hampton, VA (ASNE)	Attendee registration not yet open	Maintenance execution: the Navy corrosion event